

THE SECOND CUP

What to drink in the dark



Winter wants a darker cup than the bright green teas of spring. Reach for the roasted ones: *hōjicha*, bancha fired over charcoal until it turns amber and toasty, almost no caffeine — the right thing for four o'clock, when you want warmth without keeping yourself up. Or *genmaicha*, green tea cut with roasted brown rice, nutty and forgiving and impossible to brew bitter.

Both are cheap, both are gentle, and both reward the slow pour. Keep a tin of one by the tetsubin through the cold months. The ritual is the same; the season just changes what's in the pot.

*"A roasted cup for the dark months.
Warmth without keeping yourself awake."*